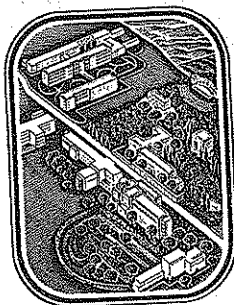


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THE
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UNIVERSITY
JERUSALEM

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Erratum: Page 2, col. 1, line 6 should read:—
The celebrations will officially begin on May 5th.

TWENTY-FIVE YEARS

By Professor LEON ROTH,
Dean of the Faculty of Humanities



The writer of the article.

THE University's first students were enrolled in a disused hut equipped by way of furniture with an orange box, and the famous inauguration took place on a rickety wooden platform suspended over an abyss: how we trembled as distinguished visitors planted themselves over-confidently on their precarious chairs! Even in 1928, when we started undergraduate teaching, we lectured in a hired building in town; and when at last the library was finished, it was a question whether it should be opened publicly: the period was that after the riots of 1929! And now, the cynics might say, we are back where we started. We are a bit beyond huts and orange boxes and wooden platforms but we are again in hired buildings in town, and so far as books and laboratory equipment are concerned we are forced to be satisfied with what we pick up. Plus ça change, plus c'est la même chose!

What then have we gained during this quarter of a century? I should say three things: a vocabulary, a tradition, and an understanding of needs. In a sense these three are one, but it will be convenient to treat them separately.

A Vocabulary...

By a "vocabulary" I mean primarily the power of self-expression in the Hebrew language. I am well aware that just as there were kings before Agamemnon, so there were writers in Hebrew on scientific subjects before the founding of the University. But what was once occasional and a tour de force became in the University a matter of ordinary (because necessary) routine. Systematic works such as those of Professor Bergmann on the Theory of Knowledge or of Professor Fraenkel on Fundamental Ideas in the Higher Mathematics or of Professor Klausner on Modern Hebrew Literature or of the late Professor Eig on the Flora and Fauna of Palestine would not have been possible but for the existence of an institution of higher learning devoted to regular teaching. I have chosen these examples specifically. They are not translations from other languages or adaptations of existing works; nor are they pieces of research meant for a narrow circle of specialists. They are extensive and original treatments of standard subjects by recognised authorities writing in Hebrew for the use of students.

All of the University staff have taken part in similar work in their own subjects, and I am not singling these out for special commendation. I am only offering illustrations of my first point: we have contested in actual practice the old objection to a Hebrew University. "A Hebrew University?" (we were told) "Quite impossible!" We have definitely shown on the contrary, in this quarter of a century, that it is not only possible. It is a vivid and active fact.

A Tradition...

The second thing we have gained is a tradition. By tradition I mean a way of living. The University exists now not on paper only; nor is it a mere group of dead buildings. It is alive in nearly a thousand Masters of Arts and Science, a hundred Doctors of Philosophy and (this year) almost fifteen hundred undergraduates. It is alive in five faculties (Arts, Science, Law, Agriculture and Medicine) comprising ninety-nine full-time professors and lecturers; in a secretariat and an administration; in numberless committees; in an international Board of Governors and a local Executive Council. It is alive in syllabuses of study; in a University Press; in a thousand and one details of academic and general organisation. These

(Continued on Page 2)

SEMI-JUBILEE IN MAY

FESTIVAL PLANNED IN JERUSALEM

IN May 1950, the Hebrew University will celebrate its 25th anniversary. To mark the occasion a special festival is now being arranged, and it is anticipated that a large number of visitors from all over Israel and abroad will participate.

The celebrations will officially begin on April 4 with the formal installation of Prof. S. Brodetsky as President of the University.

During its first 25 years the University has developed from three small research institutes (Microbiology, Chemistry and Jewish Studies) into a full-fledged institution with Faculties of Humanities, Science, Medicine, Law, a School of Agriculture, a Department of Social Sciences and Economics, a Department of Education, a University Press, and a Jewish National and University Library with more than 500,000 volumes. The University was formally inaugurated on Mount Scopus on April 1, 1925, by the late Lord Balfour, in the presence of a throng numbering 7000, including Lord Allenby, Lord Samuel, then High Commissioner, eminent scientists and scholars.

In the week of the semi-Jubilee there will be a Conference of Friends of the Hebrew University during which world Jewry's link with the Hebrew University will be fully discussed. Other features include academic lectures, Students' and Graduates' Rallies, sports meetings, a University Exhibition, and private and public reception. Opportunity will be made of the occasion to restore Jerusalem as the centre of Israel's cultural life and gala theatrical, musical, ballet and opera performances are being organised.

In all countries of the Diaspora, Friends are also planning to celebrate the Semi-Jubilee of the Hebrew University, not only in April, but throughout the year. A special illustrated book containing history and reminiscences of these 25 years of achievement will be issued by the University to mark the occasion.

Competitions have been conducted within Israel for an official badge for the University, and for the words and music of a University anthem.

EDITORIAL (Continued from Page 1)

are realities which are not created in a moment. They are built up in the light of slow experience. External critics may detect weaknesses and suggest improvements, and even the architects do not pretend to be completely satisfied. But the machine exists, and as such is a force. The University may be housed again in hired premises, but in the meanwhile it has learned to work as a University.

An Understanding of Needs...

Learning to work as a University means not only the establishment of a tradition. It means that we now know what we require. The mere every day working has revealed to us the nature of our requirements as a University. We now know that, e.g., an orange box is no substitute for an office or a ruined hut for a laboratory. We now know that a subject cannot be given by one teacher only and that lectures are no substitute for a library. Both in the arts and in the sciences we have found out the minimum below which we cannot go and the maximum to which we should aspire.

Some will regret the passing of the old heroic days, but we cannot be 'halutzim' for ever. Not

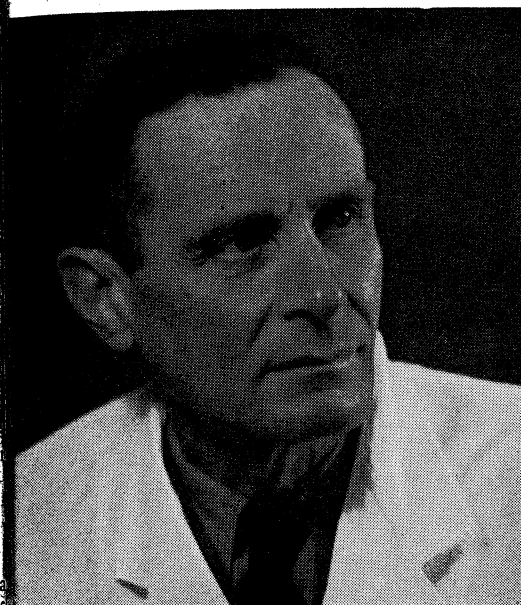
that the Halutz spirit has ceased to be needed. Only pioneers will come to us for a long time yet. But the pioneers who come now, whether teachers or as students, will come to a running institution which knows what it needs.

This understanding of the requirements of University life seems to me to be our alkimportant step forward. We have become 'University-conscious'. We now see that the University is a necessity both for local and for international Jewish life; and this necessity is felt both for the 'matter' and the 'spirit', both for the body of Jewry and for its soul. All the old controversies about the 'mission' of the University are resolved in this understanding that all conceptions were right. We need both teaching and research, both the arts and the sciences; we serve the State of Israel and world-Jewry as one.

And this is no insignificant part of our progress. It is of its essence. The University is coming to mean what it was bound to mean, and in this consciousness of this fact it is revealing itself both to the world and to its self. To put it prosily, in this quarter of a century the University has begun to grow up.

UNIVERSITY PERSONALITIES

PROFESSOR A. L. OLITZKI



At this time he started his career at the Hebrew University as an Instructor, and in addition from 1929 to 1932 served as head of the Hadassah Department of Clinical Bacteriology in Jerusalem. In 1934 he became lecturer in Serology at the University, and in 1944, after the death of the late Prof. Kligler, he was made acting head of the Department. In 1947 Dr. Olitzki visited institutions in Europe to study and compare methods of teaching in various countries in preparation for the undergraduate instruction in the Medical School. He attended that year the International Congress for Microbiology in Copenhagen and was appointed as vice-president in the Section of General Microbiology and member of the Permanent International Commission for the Congress, which will take place in Rio de Janeiro this year. He now lectures to Medical students and to Science students who take bacteriology. When the undergraduate Medical School was inaugurated, the Department of Bacteriology and Hygiene was divided into two departments, and Prof. Olitzki was appointed head of the Department of Bacteriology.

In the earlier period Prof. Olitzki's work was concerned with research into enteric, infectious diseases peculiar to this country, such as typhoid and dysentery. The department in which he cooperated with Prof. Kligler, had studied the prevention of infectious diseases, especially the influence of climate, nutrition, and environment on the course of these diseases. When the State of Israel was established, Dr. Olitzki participated as adviser in some committees appointed by the Ministry of Health dealing with acute problems of the public health such as the preparation and standardisation of vaccines against typhoid fever, typhus, rabies etc., the reporting of communicable diseases by the physicians to the Government authorities, and the standardisation of the diagnostic laboratory methods.

During the siege of Jerusalem Dr. Olitzki did vital work in helping to keep the city supplied with pure water after the pipeline had been cut. His work in charge of the laboratory for testing and chlorinating water was a factor of importance enabling Jerusalem to hold out.

PROFESSOR Arie Leo Olitzki, who was recently appointed head of the Department of Bacteriology, came to Palestine in 1924 among a group of young people who were members of the Zionist Student Organisation in Germany.

Born at Allenstein in Germany, he studied medicine at Breslau and Berlin, graduating as M.D. at the latter University in 1921. His thesis for his doctorate was on the Bacteriology of Eye-Diseases, a subject he believed would be of great benefit in Palestine, where these diseases were common. He became so interested in this work and in the scientific methods of investigation which it required that he chose to continue in the research field rather than enter general medical practice. To gain more experience he continued post-graduate research at Breslau from 1921 to 1924. With this background and experience it was natural for the young Dr. Olitzki to turn to laboratory work when he reached Palestine. He served at the Hadassah Hospital in Jerusalem for two years before being transferred to Safad in 1926 as head of the Hadassah laboratory there. In 1928 he went to Breslau for further studies, and in his return six months later he found that the Safad Hospital had been converted into a Tuberculosis Centre.